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91
50-32

Final

103
68-14


OKC

Gamecast

Recap

Box Score

Play-by-Play

Team Stats

Videos

Game 7: Shai Gilgeous-Alexander scores 29 points and Thunder beat Pacers 103-91 for NBA title

By AP
Jun 23, 2025, 09:45 pm



OKLAHOMA CITY -- — [Shai Gilgeous-Alexander](#) walked off the court for the final time this season, collapsed into the arms of coach Mark Daigneault and finally smiled.

It was over.

The climb is complete. The rebuild is done. The [Oklahoma City Thunder](#) are champions.

The best team all season was the best team at the end, bringing the NBA title to Oklahoma City for the first time. Gilgeous-Alexander finished off his MVP season with 29 points and 12 assists, and the Thunder beat the [Indiana Pacers](#) — [who lost Tyrese Haliburton](#) to a serious leg injury in the opening minutes — 103-91 in Game 7 of the NBA Finals on Sunday night.

“It doesn’t feel real,” said Gilgeous-Alexander, the Finals MVP. “So many hours. So many moments. So many emotions. So many nights of disbelief. So many nights of belief. It’s crazy to know that we’re all here, but this group worked for it. This group put in the hours and we deserve this.”

[Jalen Williams](#) scored 20 points and [Chet Holmgren](#) had 18 for the Thunder, who finished off a season for the ages. Oklahoma City won 84 games between the regular season and the playoffs, tying the 1996-97 [Chicago Bulls](#) for third most in any season.

Only Golden State (88 in 2016-17) and the Bulls (87 in 2015-16) won more.

It’s the second championship for the franchise. The Seattle SuperSonics won the NBA title in 1979; the team was moved to Oklahoma City in 2008. There’s nothing in the rafters in Oklahoma City to commemorate that title.

MATCHUPS

Regular Season

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IND

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111

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91

GAME INFORMATION

 5:30 AM, June

In October, a championship banner is finally coming. A Thunder banner.

“They behave like champions. They compete like champions,” Daigneault said. “They root for each other’s success, which is rare in professional sports. I’ve said it many times and now I’m going to say it one more time. They are an uncommon team and now they’re champions.”

The Pacers led 48-47 at the half even after losing Haliburton to what his father said was an Achilles tendon injury about seven minutes into the game. But they were outscored 34-20 in the third quarter as the Thunder built a 13-point lead and began to run away.

“Deflated, but proud of everything we’ve accomplished,” Pacers guard TJ McConnell said.

[Bennedict Mathurin](#) had 24 points and 13 rebounds for Indiana, which still is waiting for its first NBA title. The Pacers — who were 10-15 after 25 games and were bidding to be the first team in NBA history to turn that bad of a start into a championship — had leads of 1-0 and 2-1 in the series, but they simply didn’t have enough in the end.

Home teams improved to 16-4 in [NBA Finals](#) Game 7s. And the Thunder became the seventh champion in the last seven seasons, a run of parity like none other in NBA history.

Pacers forward [Pascal Siakam](#) was part of the Toronto team that won in 2019, Thunder guard [Alex Caruso](#) was part of the [Los Angeles Lakers](#) team that won in the pandemic “bubble” in 2020, Milwaukee won in 2021, Golden State in 2022, Pacers forward [Thomas Bryant](#) and Denver prevailed in 2023, and Boston won last year’s title.



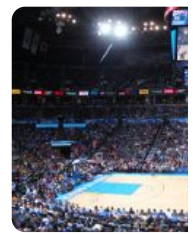
And now, the Thunder get their turn. The youngest team to win a title in nearly a half-century has reached the NBA mountaintop.

The Thunder are the ninth franchise to win a title in NBA Commissioner Adam Silver's 12 seasons. His predecessor, David Stern, saw eight franchises win titles in his 30 seasons as commissioner.

“It really hurts on the one hand,” Pacers coach Rick Carlisle said. “On the other hand, this team has given all of Pacer Nation something to be very proud of.”

AP NBA: <https://apnews.com/hub/NBA>

Paycom Centre
Oklahoma City



Attendance: 18,000

Where to Watch
[ABC](#) [ESPN+](#)

Officiating Crew
Referee: Jame
Referee: Jame
Referee: Sean
Referee: Josh

2025-26 STANDINGS

Eastern Conference

CENTRAL

Detroit

Cleveland

Milwaukee

Chicago

Indiana

Western Conference

NORTHWEST

Oklahoma City

Denver

Minnesota

Portland

Utah

[Full](#)

NBA NEWS



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